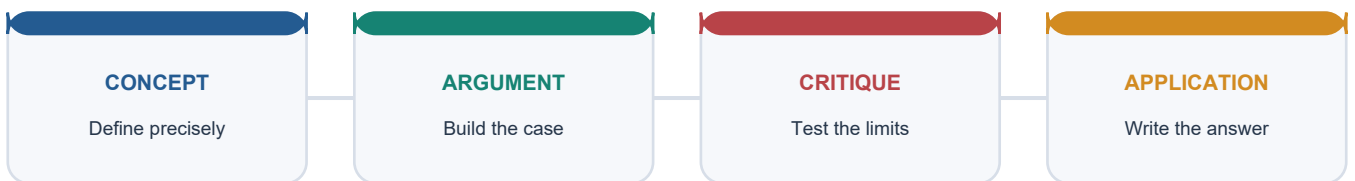


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 05 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Evolutionary / democratic socialism**?

- A. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.
- B. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.
- C. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.
- D. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Evolutionary / democratic socialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Lassalle and Bernstein, not Evolutionary / democratic socialism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Anarchism vs disorder, not Evolutionary / democratic socialism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Fascism vs liberalism, not Evolutionary / democratic socialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Evolutionary / democratic socialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 2

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Leader principle**?

- A. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (Section 13 verdict, Section 17 Chain 3).
- B. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.
- C. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.
- D. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to "Critically examine", not Leader principle.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Leader principle.
- **C:** C Attaches to Paternalistic / "one nation", not Leader principle.
- **D:** D Attaches to Socialism vs Marxism, not Leader principle.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Leader principle by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 3

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Socialism vs Marxism**?

- A. Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism, and show why it does not (Section 13 verdict, Section 17 Chain 3).
- B. concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.
- C. socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.
- D. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to "Critically examine", not Socialism vs Marxism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Leader principle, not Socialism vs Marxism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Socialism vs Marxism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Fascism vs liberalism, not Socialism vs Marxism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Socialism vs Marxism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 4

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism**?

- A. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.
- B. Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.
- C. Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 19).
- D. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Anarchism vs disorder, not Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness, not Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism.
- **C:** C Cross-attached: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 5

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Fascism vs liberalism**?

- A. fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.
- B. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.
- C. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.
- D. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A States the source-recorded proposition for Fascism vs liberalism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Lassalle and Bernstein, not Fascism vs liberalism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Evolutionary / democratic socialism, not Fascism vs liberalism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Anarchism vs disorder, not Fascism vs liberalism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Fascism vs liberalism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 6

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Fascism vs Marxism**?

- A. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.
- B. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest.
- C. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.
- D. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to New Right (market + authority), not Fascism vs Marxism.
- **B:** B States the source-recorded proposition for Fascism vs Marxism.
- **C:** C Attaches to Fascism vs socialism/communism, not Fascism vs Marxism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Paternalistic / "one nation", not Fascism vs Marxism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Fascism vs Marxism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 7

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Fascism vs socialism/communism**?

- A. A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.
- B. Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.
- C. fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits.
- D. fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest, whereas Marxism makes class conflict central.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to New Right (market + authority), not Fascism vs socialism/communism.
- **B:** B Attaches to Paternalistic / "one nation", not Fascism vs socialism/communism.
- **C:** C States the source-recorded proposition for Fascism vs socialism/communism.
- **D:** D Attaches to Fascism vs Marxism, not Fascism vs socialism/communism.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Fascism vs socialism/communism by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 8

Which proposition is correctly associated with **Anarchism vs disorder**?

- A. one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.
- B. socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.
- C. examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.
- D. most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Attaches to Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism, not Anarchism vs disorder.
- **B:** B Attaches to Evolutionary / democratic socialism, not Anarchism vs disorder.
- **C:** C Attaches to Lassalle and Bernstein, not Anarchism vs disorder.
- **D:** D States the source-recorded proposition for Anarchism vs disorder.

Examiner trap: Do not identify Anarchism vs disorder by a neighbouring proposition merely because both occur in the same topic.

MCQ 9

Which thinker/concept-proposition pair is correctly matched?

- A. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness - Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.
- B. Mark-weight cue (10/15) - Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (Section 22.8 Chain 1); no additional distinction is made within this interpretation.
- C. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism - most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.
- D. Accuracy limit - A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired; this option treats that proposition as the decisive account.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Records the association: Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Misplaced: Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism is recorded with one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.
- **D:** D Belongs elsewhere: Accuracy limit is recorded with do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 10

Which of the following pairs a name or concept with the proposition the source actually records for it?

- A. Evolutionary / democratic socialism - socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian.
- B. Lassalle and Bernstein - examples of democratic/evolutionary socialism that revise Marxist expectations about class conflict and political method.
- C. Fascism vs liberalism - one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.
- D. Anarchism vs disorder - Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Evolutionary / democratic socialism is recorded with socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.
- **B:** B Records the association: Lassalle and Bernstein is associated with this proposition.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Fascism vs liberalism is recorded with fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.
- **D:** D Cross-attached: Anarchism vs disorder is recorded with most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Lassalle and Bernstein; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 11

In which pair does the proposition genuinely belong to the label placed against it?

- A. Warrant for change - Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (Section 22.8 Chain 1).
- B. Technology / economy - do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that
- C. Equality vs hierarchy - Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.
- D. View of the state - Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 19).

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Misplaced: Warrant for change is recorded with Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Technology / economy is recorded with Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.
- **C:** C Matches the record: Equality vs hierarchy is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Mismatched: View of the state is recorded with A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Equality vs hierarchy; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 12

Only one pairing below reproduces the source's own association. Which is it?

- A. View of the state - Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 19).
- B. Equality vs hierarchy - Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (Section 22.8 Chain 1).
- C. Warrant for change - do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that
- D. Technology / economy - Accepts modern productive organization but regulates it.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Belongs elsewhere: View of the state is recorded with A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.
- **B:** B Cross-attached: Equality vs hierarchy is recorded with Seeks socio-economic equality through public control.
- **C:** C Mismatched: Warrant for change is recorded with Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.
- **D:** D Correct attachment: Technology / economy is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Technology / economy; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 13

Identify the pair in which the recorded proposition matches its label exactly.

- A. "Critically examine" - Test whether fascism belongs with the other three as an "equality-seeking" critique of capitalism.
- B. Leader principle - fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider.
- C. Socialism vs Marxism - fascism exalts the state as an end and reduces the individual to a means, the reverse of the liberal individual-as-end premise.

- D. Paternalistic / "one nation" - fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Kept where the source puts it: "Critically examine" is associated with this proposition.
- **B:** B Mismatched: Leader principle is recorded with concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Socialism vs Marxism is recorded with socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.
- **D:** D Wrong attachment: Paternalistic / "one nation" is recorded with Those with advantage owe obligation to those without; social division is itself a threat to order, so amelioration is a conservative duty, not a socialist concession.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to "Critically examine"; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 14

Which one of the following label-proposition pairings survives a strict source check?

- A. Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism - A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.
- B. Mark-weight cue (10/15) - Scale the number of doctrines/thinkers cited and depth of objection-reply chain (Section 19).
- C. Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness - Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (Section 22.8 Chain 1).
- D. Accuracy limit - most anarchists still recognize expert authority and morally binding collective decisions taken democratically.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Mismatched: Evolutionary vs revolutionary socialism is recorded with one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Not this pair: Gandhian statelessness vs normlessness is recorded with Gandhi's self-regulated order depends on moral discipline, not absence of social norms.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: Accuracy limit is recorded with do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Mark-weight cue (10/15); nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 15

Which pairing below would a careful source check leave standing?

- A. Unit 2 - Claim - fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider.
- B. Unit 6 - Claim - A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis.
- C. Unit 1 - Claim - democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney.
- D. Unit 3 - Claim - fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Not this pair: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **B:** B Wrong attachment: Unit 6 - Claim is recorded with mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> Named: Peter Kropotkin -> Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75) -> Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78).
- **C:** C Faithful pairing: Unit 1 - Claim is associated with this proposition.
- **D:** D Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Unit 1 - Claim; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 16

Which of these attributions is reproduced correctly rather than shifted to a neighbouring idea?

- A. Unit 6 - Claim - fascism denies the economic conception of history and class conflict, replacing it with the myth of an indivisible national interest.
- B. Unit 3 - Claim - A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis.
- C. Unit 1 - Claim - fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider.
- D. Unit 2 - Claim - revolutionary trade unions and the general strike are the chief instrument of transformative struggle -> Named: Georges Sorel -> Significance:.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Wrong attachment: Unit 6 - Claim is recorded with mutual aid and sociability, not competitive struggle, are the natural basis for cooperative order -> Named: Peter Kropotkin -> Significance: gives anarchism a positive, constructive account of how a stateless society could function, not merely a negative anti-state stance (Gaub, PDF p.75) -> Limitation: critics say it is over-optimistic about human cooperation at large scale (Gaub, PDF p.78).
- **B:** B Source disagrees: this proposition is recorded elsewhere in the topic and is not the association the stem asks about.
- **C:** C Belongs elsewhere: Unit 1 - Claim is recorded with democracy can be redefined to include control over wealth production, achieved through existing constitutional machinery -> Named: Sydney Webb -> Significance: gives Fabianism a precise reformist mechanism distinct from revolutionary Marxism (Gaub, PDF pp.58-59) -> Limitation: relies on the patience and goodwill of gradual legislative majorities, which critics say can stall or reverse.
- **D:** D Faithful pairing: Unit 2 - Claim is associated with this proposition.

Examiner trap: Keep the exact proposition attached to Unit 2 - Claim; nearby thinkers may address the same debate from a different mechanism.

MCQ 17

Consider the following statements:

1. **Unit 3 - Claim** is associated with: love and non-obedience to immoral commands, not organized violence, should govern political relations -> Named: Leo Tolstoy -> Significance: supplies the clearest pacifist-Christian anarchist position and a widely attested influence on Gandhian non-violence (Gaub, PDF p.77; Section 12.3) -> Limitation: as a purely moral-individual position, it offers little institutional guidance for large-scale collective coordination.
2. **Paternalistic / "one nation"** is associated with: Presumptively legitimate until it demonstrably fails (Section 22.8 Chain 1).

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Unit 3 - Claim does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 18

Consider the following statements:

1. **Unit 6 - Claim** is associated with: A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.
2. **New Right (market + authority)** is associated with: A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Unit 6 - Claim does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 19

Consider the following statements:

1. **Accuracy limit** is associated with: do not claim Oakeshott defends a specific institutional programme, or that
2. **Warrant for change** is associated with: Demonstrated malfunction of a particular arrangement.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Accuracy limit does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 20

Consider the following statements:

1. **Paternalistic / "one nation"** is associated with: A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.
2. **View of the state** is associated with: socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Paternalistic / "one nation" does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 21

Consider the following statements:

1. **New Right (market + authority)** is associated with: A composite: market liberalism in economics (deregulation, privatisation, rolled-back state) combined with a socially authoritarian emphasis on order, nation and traditional morality.
2. **View of inherited hierarchy** is associated with: one seeks gradual democratic transition; the other seeks revolutionary overthrow of capitalism.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is correct.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with New Right (market + authority) does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 22

Consider the following statements:

1. **Warrant for change** is associated with: socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.
2. **Evolutionary / democratic socialism** is associated with: socialism pursued gradually, constitutionally and democratically rather than through wholesale revolutionary rupture.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is correct.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with Warrant for change does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 23

Consider the following statements:

1. **View of the state** is associated with: A historically grown inheritance to be conserved and repaired.
2. **Leader principle** is associated with: concentration of unconditional authority in a supreme leader/dictator whose will is treated as law, with the individual holding no rights against the state.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is correct.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is correct; Statement 2 is correct. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is not the right combination.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with View of the state does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 24

Consider the following statements:

1. **View of inherited hierarchy** is associated with: socialism is a wider family; Gauba's own exposition includes democratic, Fabian, revisionist and syndicalist variants beyond Marxian revolution.
2. **Socialism vs Marxism** is associated with: fascism is counter-revolutionary and hierarchical, protecting concentrated capital, while communism (even when coercive) seeks wider distribution of benefits to the masses.

Which option is correct?

- A. 1 only
- B. 2 only
- C. Both 1 and 2
- D. Neither 1 nor 2

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '1 only' is not the right combination.
- **B:** B Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore '2 only' is not the right combination.
- **C:** C Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Both 1 and 2' is not the right combination.
- **D:** D Statement 1 is incorrect; Statement 2 is incorrect. Therefore 'Neither 1 nor 2' is correct.

Examiner trap: Test each statement independently; familiarity with View of inherited hierarchy does not validate the second pairing.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Socialism is just another word for Marxism.?**

- A. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)
- B. Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)
- C. Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)
- D. His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Anarchism means chaos.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi wanted no social norms at all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Socialism is just another word for Marxism, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so they belong together.?**

- A. Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct.
- B. Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the.
- C. Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to.
- D. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the two stand for opposite social values despite both criticizing unregulated capitalism. (PDF pp.55-56, 66).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like liberalism or Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like liberalism or Marxism.?**

- A. Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the.
- B. Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct.
- C. Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to.
- D. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so they belong together.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to the study of "political pathology." (PDF pp.64-65).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical.?**

- A. Gauba states fascism wove unrelated principles into an incoherent whole to meet political exigencies and never developed a consistent theory; it belongs to.
- B. Gauba is explicit that fascism rejects equality and substitutes hierarchy, while socialism (in all its variants) seeks equality through public control; the.
- C. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)
- D. Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Fascism is a coherent political philosophy like liberalism or Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Fascism and socialism are both "collectivist," so they belong together.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba treats Nazism as fascism's chief variant sharing many features (leader principle, single party, anti-liberal/anti-Marxist stance) but adding a distinct racist doctrine that Italian fascism did not centre in the same way. (PDF pp.64, 69).

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Mussolini's Italy and Hitler's Germany were identical, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Anarchism means chaos.**?

- A. Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)
- B. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)
- C. Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)
- D. His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74).
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi wanted no social norms at all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Anarchism means chaos, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gandhi wanted no social norms at all.**?

- A. Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)
- B. His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)
- C. Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)
- D. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Anarchism means chaos.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Directly repairs the stated misconception: His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83).
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gandhi wanted no social norms at all, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society.**?

- A. His stateless ideal depends on truth, non-violence, self-discipline and moral responsibility. (PDF pp.79-83)
- B. Gauba says most anarchists accept rational expert authority and moral authority of democratic collective decisions. (PDF p.74)
- C. Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83)
- D. Gauba treats socialism as a wider family including evolutionary, Fabian, revisionist, syndicalist and other variants. (PDF pp.55-63)

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi wanted no social norms at all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Anarchism means chaos.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gauba's comparison shows deep differences on religion, technology, class conflict, state and method. (PDF pp.82-83).
- **D:** D Repairs a different misconception, 'Socialism is just another word for Marxism.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both, not a different error from the same topic.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which correction is most defensible for the claim: **Trap: "Gandhi appealed to village tradition, therefore Gandhi is a conservative."**?

- A. Gauba says most anarchists accept.
- B. His stateless ideal depends on.
- C. Gauba's comparison shows deep.
- D. Gandhi

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A Repairs a different misconception, 'Anarchism means chaos.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **B:** B Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi wanted no social norms at all.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **C:** C Repairs a different misconception, 'Gandhi and Marx are basically the same because both mention classless society.', so it does not answer the claim in the stem.
- **D:** D Directly repairs the stated misconception: Gandhi.

Examiner trap: Repair the exact overstatement about Trap: "Gandhi appealed to village tradition,, not a different error from the same topic.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for **Socialism, Fascism, Anarchism and Gandhism** in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Distinguish democratic socialism from revolutionary socialism. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *distinguish* requires the answer to fix each side of the distinction precisely and show where it does the analytical work. Fix the boundary of democratic socialism from revolutionary socialism in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Democratic and Fabianism, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Both seek social control of production, but democratic socialism treats constitutional reform as the route to equality whereas revolutionary socialism seeks a rupture with capitalist institutions.

Model answer (150 words):

Introduction: Both democratic and revolutionary socialism seek social control of production for common welfare, but they differ over method and institutional continuity. Core analysis: Democratic socialism pursues gradual change through elections, legislation, administration, trade unions and public persuasion. Fabianism exemplifies this evolutionary strategy, while Lassalle and Bernstein revise revolutionary expectations in favour of constitutional reform. Revolutionary socialism holds that capitalist ownership and class power cannot be transformed adequately within existing institutions and therefore requires a decisive rupture. The disagreement concerns not the goal of overcoming exploitation alone, but whether the state and parliamentary system can become instruments of transition. Critical evaluation: Democratic socialism reduces coercive risk but may be absorbed by capitalism; revolutionary socialism targets structural power more directly but risks authoritarian concentration. Conclusion: Both seek social control of production, but democratic socialism treats constitutional reform as the route to equality whereas revolutionary socialism seeks a rupture with capitalist institutions.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *distinguish* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Democratic and Fabianism), converts that evidence into analysis of democratic socialism from revolutionary socialism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Both seek social control of production, but democratic socialism treats constitutional reform as the route to equality whereas revolutionary socialism seeks a rupture with capitalist institutions. At 150 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: Why is anarchism a theory of non-coercive order rather than a defence of disorder? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *why* requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of is anarchism a theory of non-coercive order rather than a defence of disorder in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Anarchism, Core and Proudhon's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that these challenge feasibility, but do not convert anarchism into a defence of chaos.

Model answer (147 words):

Introduction: Anarchism rejects the coercive authority of the sovereign state, not every rule, association or form of coordination. Core analysis: Proudhon's mutualism envisages autonomous associations and reciprocal exchange; Kropotkin grounds cooperation in mutual aid and distribution by need; Bakunin favours revolutionary collectivism. These positions assume that social order can arise through voluntary federation, custom, reciprocity and democratically accepted obligation. Anarchists may also distinguish coercive command from expert authority, which is followed because of competence rather than a legal right to obedience. The doctrine is therefore a normative account of order without a coercive superior. Critical evaluation: Its unresolved problems are scale, public goods, security and

hidden informal domination. These challenge feasibility, but do not convert anarchism into a defence of chaos. Conclusion: Anarchism rejects coercive sovereignty, not coordination itself; its viability therefore turns on whether voluntary association can meet the problems of scale, security and hidden authority.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Anarchism, Core and Proudhon's), converts that evidence into analysis of is anarchism a theory of non-coercive order rather than a defence of disorder, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that these challenge feasibility, but do not convert anarchism into a defence of chaos. At 147 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Critically examine fascism as a political pathology rather than a coherent political philosophy. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive critically examine requires the answer to test the proposition against its strongest objection before giving a verdict. Fix the boundary of examine fascism as a political pathology rather than a coherent political philosophy in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Fascism, Core and Mussolini's Italian, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Fascism's cult of leadership, myth and violence can mobilise power, but its rejection of reason, liberty and equality prevents it from offering a defensible political philosophy.

Model answer (139 words):

Introduction: Fascism is better understood as a totalitarian mobilisation of power than as a systematic and defensible political philosophy. Core analysis: It combines extreme nationalism, hierarchy, the leader principle, single-party rule, myth over reason and violence as a political instrument. Mussolini's Italian fascism opposed liberalism, democracy and Marxism, while Nazism added an explicitly racial myth and should not be treated as identical in every respect. Fascism preserved concentrated capital while removing democratic and welfare restraints, destroyed plural institutions and reduced individuals to means of the total state. Critical evaluation: Its internal incoherence does not make it harmless: precisely because myth and authority replace rational justification, Gauba's description of political pathology is apt. Conclusion: Fascism's cult of leadership, myth and violence can mobilise power, but its rejection of reason, liberty and equality prevents it from offering a defensible political philosophy.

Why this earns marks: it obeys critically examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Fascism, Core and Mussolini's Italian), converts that evidence into analysis of examine fascism as a political pathology rather than a coherent political philosophy, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Fascism's cult of leadership, myth and violence can mobilise power, but its rejection of reason, liberty and equality prevents it from offering a defensible political philosophy. At 139 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Evaluate Gandhi as a moral and decentralist anarchist. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive evaluate requires the answer to apply a stated criterion and give a graded verdict, not a summary. Fix the boundary of gandhi as a moral and decentralist anarchist in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Gandhi, Core and Unlike Bakunin, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Gandhi is anarchist in his ideal of self-rule and minimal coercion, but reformist in method because satyagraha and constructive work replace insurrection.

Model answer (219 words):

Introduction: Gandhi has a strong anarchist affinity because swaraj ultimately means disciplined self-rule with the least possible dependence on coercive state authority. Core analysis: His preferred order rests on decentralised communities, voluntary cooperation, ahimsa and satyagraha. Unlike Bakunin, Gandhi rejects violent insurrection and insists that means must embody the desired end. Trusteeship seeks to transform property into social stewardship, bread labour affirms the dignity of productive work, and Sarvodaya directs politics toward the welfare of all, beginning with the weakest. The moral discipline of citizens, not normlessness, sustains order. Further development: The comparison with Tolstoy and classical anarchists clarifies the classification. Tolstoy's pacifist-Christian refusal of

immoral commands influences Gandhi's moral anti-statism, while Proudhon, Kropotkin and Bakunin construct different institutional or revolutionary routes beyond the state. Gandhi adds disciplined non-violence, village self-government and a programme of social reconstruction. The qualification is decisive: he does not demand immediate abolition of every state function, and his economic transition relies more heavily on conversion and trusteeship than on coercive expropriation. Critical evaluation: Gandhi is therefore anarchist in the regulative ideal of a self-governing society but pragmatic and reformist in political method. Trusteeship's dependence on moral conversion remains its major weakness. Conclusion: Gandhi is anarchist in his ideal of self-rule and minimal coercion, but reformist in method because satyagraha and constructive work replace insurrection.

Why this earns marks: it obeys evaluate instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Gandhi, Core and Unlike Bakunin), converts that evidence into analysis of Gandhi as a moral and decentralist anarchist, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Gandhi is anarchist in his ideal of self-rule and minimal coercion, but reformist in method because satyagraha and constructive work replace insurrection. At 219 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Compare socialism, anarchism, Gandhism and fascism on liberty, equality, state and property. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive compare requires the answer to run the comparison on shared axes and end with the decisive difference. Fix the boundary of socialism, anarchism, Gandhism and fascism on liberty, equality, state and property in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Core, Socialism and Anarchism, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conclusion: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism offer rival emancipatory responses to domination, whereas fascism is the outlier because it openly subordinates liberty and equality to hierarchy and the total state.

Model answer (241 words):

Introduction: The four doctrines respond to modern capitalism and political authority through sharply different moral priorities. Core analysis: Socialism seeks equality and common welfare through social ownership or control, with democratic and revolutionary variants differing over the state. Anarchism treats coercive authority as the principal domination and seeks voluntary federation, though its property positions vary. Gandhism combines self-rule, non-violence, trusteeship and decentralised production, making ethical means central to liberty and equality. Fascism instead subordinates the individual to the leader and total state, affirms hierarchy and preserves concentrated property under authoritarian control. Further development: The transition mechanisms also differ. Democratic socialism uses constitutional state power to socialise control; revolutionary socialism seeks rupture; anarchism replaces sovereignty with voluntary federation; Gandhism uses moral self-rule, constructive work and non-violent resistance; fascism concentrates power in leader and party. Their treatment of property follows the diagnosis of domination: social control for socialists, varied mutual or communal arrangements for anarchists, trusteeship for Gandhi, and concentrated private ownership under political subordination for fascism. The comparison must therefore avoid the superficial claim that all anti-liberal doctrines are alike. Critical evaluation: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism can be compared as rival emancipatory projects. Fascism must remain the outlier because it rejects the equal moral standing that gives the other three their critical purpose. Conclusion: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism offer rival emancipatory responses to domination, whereas fascism is the outlier because it openly subordinates liberty and equality to hierarchy and the total state.

Why this earns marks: it obeys compare instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Core, Socialism and Anarchism), converts that evidence into analysis of socialism, anarchism, Gandhism and fascism on liberty, equality, state and property, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conclusion: Socialism, anarchism and Gandhism offer rival emancipatory responses to domination, whereas fascism is the outlier because it openly subordinates liberty and equality to hierarchy and the total state. At 241 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Critically analyse conservatism as prudential reform rather than resistance to all change. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of analyse conservatism as prudential reform rather than resistance to all change in the opening line, carry the argument on Introduction, Conservatism, Core and Burke's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that conservatism is defensible only when gradualism remains open to evidence, rights and the claims of those burdened by tradition.

Model answer (245 words):

Introduction: Conservatism is a disposition to preserve an inherited order through cautious change, not a doctrine that every existing institution must remain untouched. Core analysis: Burke's argument is that institutions embody accumulated experience, prescription and tacit social knowledge that abstract redesign cannot easily replace. Reform is justified when demonstrated malfunction threatens continuity: change is undertaken in order to conserve. Oakeshott adds an epistemic distinction between technical knowledge and practical knowledge embedded in tradition and judgment. Conservative strands nevertheless differ, from traditional hierarchy to paternalistic obligation and the market-oriented New Right. Further development: The internal strands reveal the limits of a single definition. Traditional conservatism emphasises authority and inherited order; paternalistic or One-Nation conservatism adds obligations toward social cohesion; the New Right combines market liberalism with conservative themes, though Hayek explicitly rejected the conservative label. Paine's counterargument remains powerful: inherited prescription cannot bind successors or legitimate injustice. The conservative reply is strongest as an epistemic caution about unintended consequences, not as proof that existing hierarchy is morally right. In the Indian context, prudence cannot excuse caste exclusion merely because it is historically embedded. Critical evaluation: Prudence can correct rationalist overconfidence, but it may also protect exclusion and inherited privilege. Conservatism is defensible only when gradualism remains open to evidence, rights and the claims of those burdened by tradition. Conclusion: Conservatism is most defensible when inherited institutions are treated as revisable stores of practical knowledge; it becomes indefensible when prudence is used to shield hierarchy or exclusion.

Why this earns marks: it obeys discuss instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Introduction, Conservatism, Core and Burke's), converts that evidence into analysis of analyse conservatism as prudential reform rather than resistance to all change, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that conservatism is defensible only when gradualism remains open to evidence, rights and the claims of those burdened by tradition. At 245 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
